

BONUS 2 OF 6

Packaging, Storage & Shelf Life.

How to store your capsules so they stay fresh, how to package them so they look professional, and exactly how long each finish actually lasts.

-  Ideal storage temperature & humidity
-  Shelf life by chocolate type and filling
-  3 packaging levels — from single wrap to gift box
-  How to prevent bloom, melting and moisture
-  Shipping & delivery tips for warm climates

Contents

Keep this open the first few times you package a batch — it becomes second nature fast.

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Introduction • Why storage decides your reputation

"A customer never tastes your best batch — they taste whatever batch survived from your kitchen to their cup. Storage isn't an afterthought, it's half of quality."

Chocolate is more sensitive than most home sellers expect. It reacts to heat, humidity, light, and even strong smells in your kitchen (chocolate absorbs odors from onions and garlic stored nearby — genuinely). None of this is complicated to manage once you know the four things that actually matter, which is exactly what this bonus covers.

✓ **The good news.** Properly tempered chocolate capsules, stored correctly, hold their snap, shine, and flavor for 3-4 weeks at room temperature — plenty of time to sell an entire batch, ship an order, or gift a kit that arrives looking freshly made.

The enemies of a good capsule

Four conditions damage chocolate capsules. Control these and everything else takes care of itself.

ENEMY	WHAT IT DOES	HOW TO AVOID IT
Heat (above 75°F / 24°C)	Melts or softens the shell, causes it to lose its shine and snap	Store in the coolest room, away from windows, stoves and appliances that generate heat
Humidity (above 60%)	Causes "sugar bloom" — a dull, grayish-white, gritty surface	Store in a sealed container with a small food-safe desiccant packet in humid climates
Temperature swings	Causes "fat bloom" — streaky white marks from cocoa butter rising to the surface	Never move capsules from cold to hot repeatedly; pick one stable storage spot
Strong odors (onion, garlic, cleaning products)	Chocolate absorbs airborne smells within hours	Always store in a sealed container, never open in the same cupboard as strong-smelling foods

⚠ Bloom isn't spoiled — but it looks unprofessional. Bloomed chocolate is still safe to eat, but the dull white streaks make it look old or low-quality. Once it happens it can't be undone without re-tempering, so prevention is much easier than the fix.

SECTION 2 OF 6

Shelf life by type

How long each chocolate type and filling actually lasts under proper storage.

TYPE	ROOM TEMP (65-70°F)	REFRIGERATED (SEALED)	NOTES
Dark chocolate shell	4-5 weeks	2-3 months	Most stable — lowest milk-fat content
Milk chocolate shell	3-4 weeks	6-8 weeks	Slightly more prone to bloom due to milk fat
White chocolate shell	2-3 weeks	4-6 weeks	Most delicate — highest fat content, softens first in heat
Powder-based fillings (coffee, milk powder, cocoa)	4-6 weeks	3+ months	Very stable — low moisture content
Paste-based fillings (hazelnut, dulce de leche)	2-3 weeks	4-5 weeks	Higher moisture/fat — the limiting factor for these flavors

Your **slowest-ageing component sets the shelf life for the whole capsule** — so a milk chocolate shell with a hazelnut paste filling should be treated as a 2-3 week product, not a 4-week one.

Print this on your label. "Best enjoyed within 3 weeks, store in a cool, dry place" is honest, professional, and sets the right customer expectation — see the label template in Section 3.

Three packaging levels

From a single wrapped capsule to a full gift box — what to use, what it costs, and when each one is worth it.

Level 1 • Single-capsule wrap

Individual clear cellophane, twist-tied or heat-sealed, with a small round sticker label carrying your logo and the flavor name. Cost: \$0.08-0.12 per unit. This is your baseline for every capsule, kit or single sale — never sell an unwrapped capsule.

Level 2 • Starter & Gift Kit boxes

A kraft or printed cardboard box (4x4x2in for 6 capsules, 6x4x2in for 12), lined with tissue paper, capsules arranged in rows or a decorative pattern. Add a small belly-band or ribbon. Cost: \$1.50-\$4.00 depending on box quality and quantity ordered.

Level 3 • Premium Gift Kit

Rigid gift box with magnetic or ribbon closure, printed insert card (see Bonus 5 for the customer instructions), and a wax seal or branded sticker. This is what justifies the \$39-45 price point from Bonus 1's margin table. Cost: \$5-7 per unit at typical craft-supply prices.

LEVEL	BEST FOR	COST/UNIT	WHERE TO BUY
1 • Single wrap	Individual sales, samples	\$0.08-0.12	Restaurant supply stores, bulk online packaging shops
2 • Starter/Gift box	Starter Box, Gift Kit	\$1.50-4.00	Craft stores, online box wholesalers
3 • Premium box	Premium Gift Kit, holidays	\$5.00-7.00	Gift packaging specialty suppliers

✓ **Label essentials.** Every package should show: flavor name, "best enjoyed within" date, and a one-line allergen note ("contains milk, may contain traces of nuts"). It looks professional and protects you.

Storing your finished batches

The exact setup for storing capsules between the day you make them and the day they're sold.

1. **Let capsules fully set** at room temperature before storing — at least 30-45 minutes after unmolding, until the shell is fully hardened and no longer tacky.
2. **Store in a single layer** inside an airtight container lined with parchment paper — stacking unwrapped capsules causes them to stick and scratch.
3. **Keep the container in your coolest cupboard**, away from the stove, dishwasher, and any window that gets direct sun.
4. **In hot climates or summer months**, a wine fridge or a dedicated mini-fridge set to 60-65°F is ideal — regular refrigerator temperatures (37-40°F) can cause condensation when capsules come back to room temperature, which triggers sugar bloom.
5. **If you must use a standard fridge**, always let capsules come back to room temperature *inside* their sealed container before opening it — this prevents condensation forming directly on the chocolate.

Shipping & hot-weather delivery

If you deliver or ship orders, a few extra steps keep capsules intact in transit.

- **Local hand delivery / pickup:** no special measures needed under 80°F — just avoid leaving boxes in a hot car.
- **Same-day local delivery in summer:** include a small reusable ice pack wrapped in a paper towel (never touching the chocolate directly) inside an insulated bag.
- **Shipping (multi-day):** only recommended in cooler months, or with insulated packaging + ice packs, and clear "keep refrigerated on arrival" instructions for the recipient.
- **Always warn customers** that a slightly softened shell after hot transport is cosmetic, not a safety issue — a quick note on your order confirmation avoids confused messages.

⚠ **Set expectations before you ship.** Most home-based capsule sellers do local delivery and pickup only, and it's a completely valid, lower-risk way to run the business — you don't need to solve nationwide shipping to hit the income targets in Bonus 1.

Your packaging checklist

Run through this every time you package a batch for sale.

Before every batch goes out the door

- | | |
|--|-----------|
| ☐ Capsules fully set (30-45 min) before wrapping | Section 4 |
| ☐ Individually wrapped, one flavor sticker each | Section 3 |
| ☐ Stored in a single layer, airtight, cool & dry | Section 4 |
| ☐ Label shows flavor + best-by date + allergen note | Section 3 |
| ☐ Hot-weather delivery? Ice pack packed separately | Section 5 |

Ready to package with confidence



✓ **Congratulations.** Your capsules will now arrive looking exactly as good as the day you made them. Next: **Bonus 3 · Sales & Promotion Guide**, to turn a well-packaged kit into your first paying customers.

Fresh, every time.

You now know exactly how to store, package and ship your capsules so every customer receives the same quality you tasted the day you made them.

Next step

Open **Bonus 3 · Sales & Promotion Guide** to start turning beautifully packaged kits into your first orders.